Installing on Windows

Please Use WSL2

We recommend using WSL2 for Rails development on Windows. This will give you a Linux environment that's much more compatible with Rails development.

Most Rails applications are developed on MacOS machines and deployed to Linux machines. This puts Windows developers at a disadvantage, as much of the helpful advice you can find online won't be geared toward you. Fortunately, Microsoft provides three tools that will provide you with an absolutely first-class developer environment:

- Windows Subsystem for Linux (WSL)[16]
- Windows Terminal[17]
- Visual Studio Code[18]

With WSL2, select the latest Ubuntu version and proceed with the instructions in *Installing on Linux*.

The following instructions are for non-WSL2 Windows installations.

First, you need to install Ruby. We recommend using the RubyInstaller for Windows package.[19] At the time of this writing, the latest version of Ruby available via RubyInstaller is Ruby 3.4.3. If you use RubyInstaller, be sure to pick a version that includes Devkit. If you use a different installer, make sure you install MSYS2 along with Ruby.

At this point, Windows Defender may intervene as it doesn't recognize the RubyInstaller package. If this happens, click the downloads folder icon to see a list of downloads. Find the download, and double-click it. You may